KCE PATHWAYS · GRADE 3 · UNIT 5: DATA AND DESIGN · WEEK 21 · READING

Partners in the Kelp Forest — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students find the main idea of a paragraph in informational text whether it is the first, middle or last sentence or not stated at all, test a main idea as too big, too small or just right, choose key details that prove the main idea and explain them with because, and connect paragraph main ideas to find the main idea of the whole text.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Title and name: the student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the Pathway Points rules together: 2 tries per question, points only for a correct first try, and the answer and reason appear after a second miss. Introduce the Monterey Bay Aquarium on Cannery Row in Monterey, California, with Itzel and her brother Joaquin and the information booklet Partners in the Kelp Forest.
2. Warm-Up, Part 1: Unit 4 Review (6 pts, 3 each): reading a play (stage directions, who is speaking, scenes) in a short script (a different script in each set).
3. Warm-Up, Part 2 (6 pts, 3 each): two more play items with the same script, including a best-summary or find-the-mistake item.
4. Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W21.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre) before any teaching. Do not help with answers; it shows what they already know.
5. Word Wrangler: 6 vocabulary cards (kelp, holdfast, blubber, sea urchin, raft, partners), each with a sentence from the booklet.
6. Picture It: The Main Idea Table. The main idea is the tabletop and key details are the legs. Show where it hides in the booklet: first (paragraphs 1, 5 and 6), middle (4), last (2), not stated (3). Ask: which sentence do ALL the other sentences help explain?
7. Read: Partners in the Kelp Forest (six paragraphs). Have the student read the heading first and ask after each paragraph, “What is this paragraph mostly about?”
8. Where Is the Main Idea Hiding? Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): choosing the main idea sentence and typing where it sits (first, middle, last), plus a not-stated main idea for paragraph 3.
9. Where Is the Main Idea Hiding? Part 2 (3 pts): a which-explanation or find-the-mistake item (the main idea is not always first, and an important word does not make a main idea).
10. Too Big, Too Small, Just Right, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): too big could fit a whole book; too small is one detail; just right covers all the details in the paragraph.
11. Too Big, Too Small, Just Right, Part 2 (3 pts): one more size test.
12. Key Details: Proof for the Main Idea, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): choosing the detail that supports a main idea and spotting a true fact that belongs to another paragraph. Tip: “This detail supports the main idea because ...”
13. Key Details: Proof for the Main Idea, Part 2 (3 pts): one more item; the reason must tell HOW the detail helps the main idea.

14. The Main Idea of the Whole Text, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): connect paragraph 4 (otters protect the kelp) and paragraph 5 (the kelp helps otters); the title and the last sentence are clues. Main idea of the whole booklet: sea otters and kelp forests help each other.
15. The Main Idea of the Whole Text, Part 2 (3 pts): the best retelling, a find-the-mistake item, or a new title with the same main idea.
16. Word Work Bonus, Part 1: Multiple-Meaning Words (XP only, not scored).
17. Word Work Bonus, Part 2: Multiple-Meaning Words (XP only, not scored).
18. Match-Up Round (10 pts, 2 per first-try match): Set 1 matches main idea words to meanings, Set 2 matches booklet words to meanings, Set 3 matches paragraphs to their main ideas.
19. Fix the Sentence (10 pts, 5 each): each item names the one kind of fix (capital letters, end mark, list commas, or one verb). The whole sentence is checked exactly; curly quotes and extra spaces are forgiven. The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
20. ⌨ Type-It Corral, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): typed vocabulary and text-detail answers; capital letters and a final period do not matter, but spelling does. The “Look back” panel is allowed.
21. ⌨ Type-It Corral, Part 2 (4 pts): more typed answers, same checking rules.
22. Speed Arena, Part 1 (XP only, not scored).
23. Speed Arena, Part 2 and Keyboard Corral (XP only, not scored).
24. Boss Battle, Part 1: Kelp Forest Challenge (10 pts, 5 each): choosing the detail that explains how kelp stands up, a which-explanation item about paragraph 6, typed booklet details and a find-the-mistake size test.
25. Boss Battle, Part 2: Kelp Forest Challenge (10 pts, 5 each): a find-the-mistake main idea, a two-step what-would-happen item, the best retelling and typed key words.
26. Pencil Break (Post): the student turns to Page 2 (Post) of the same sheet (grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W21.pdf) and completes it, plus the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score. The sheet buttons let the student open or print it again.
27. Results (Lesson Complete!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows “Main Idea Champion!” with the congratulations message “Main idea champion!” and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows “Great Effort Today!” with encouragement (“Sea otters spend a lot of time every day caring for their fur. Building a skill takes daily care too!”), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: UNIT 4 REVIEW (3 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
`w1_s0`	Set 1: *Otter Watch (Morning at the sea otter pool. Iker presses his nose to the glass.)IKER: (excited) Look, Junie! That otter is floating on its back!JUNIE: (whispering) Shh. Let’s watch it eat its lunch.(The otter cracks a shell on a rock. Iker claps.)* Which part of the script is a STAGE DIRECTION? [(The otter cracks a shell on a rock. Iker claps.) / Shh. Let’s watch it eat its lunch. / IKER: / Look, Junie!]	**(The otter cracks a shell on a rock. Iker claps.)**	Stage directions are inside parentheses. They tell what happens on stage. Actors act them out instead of saying them.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
w2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Who says, “Look, Junie! That otter is floating on its back!” Type the name.	**Iker** (also accepted: iker)	The name before the colon tells who is talking. IKER: comes right before that line.
w3_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Look at the first stage direction. The scene happens at the sea otter ___.	**pool** (also accepted: the pool)	The first stage direction says: Morning at the sea otter pool.
w4_s0	Set 1: Which is the BEST summary of Otter Watch? [At the otter pool, Iker and Junie watch an otter float on its back and crack open its lunch. / Iker presses his nose to the glass. Junie says shh. / This is the funniest play, and otters are the best. / Junie and Iker swim with the otters in the bay.]	**At the otter pool, Iker and Junie watch an otter float on its back and crack open its lunch.**	A summary tells who, where, and what happened in a few words. It leaves out tiny details and opinions.
w1_s1	Set 2: *The Touch Pool (Afternoon at the touch pool. Mr. Jarrell holds a sea star in the water.)MR. JARRELL: (smiling) Use two fingers, and touch gently.ISAIAH: (reaching in fast) Can I pick it up? MR. JARRELL: (shaking his head) Sea stars stay in the water. Just one gentle touch.(Isaiah takes a breath and slowly touches the sea star with two fingers.)* Type your answer: How many characters have speaking lines in The Touch Pool? (Type the number.)	**2** (also accepted: two)	Only MR. JARRELL and ISAIAH have names with colons in front of lines. That makes 2.
w2_s1	Set 2: What does the stage direction (reaching in fast) show about Isaiah at the start? [He is excited and in a hurry. / He is scared of the sea star. / He is the volunteer at the pool. / He is sleepy and bored.]	**He is excited and in a hurry.**	Reaching in fast shows Isaiah is rushing because he is excited.
w3_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Itzel says “Use two fingers, and touch gently” is dialogue, because it comes after MR. JARRELL and a colon. Joaquin says it is a stage direction, because it tells someone what to do. [Itzel is right. Words after a name and a colon are dialogue, even when they give directions. / Joaquin is right. Any words that tell someone what to do are stage directions. / Joaquin is right, because the line has a comma. / Neither is right. It is the title.]	**Itzel is right. Words after a name and a colon are dialogue, even when they give directions.**	Stage directions are in parentheses. Mr. Jarrell says these words out loud to Isaiah, so they are dialogue.
w4_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: Isaiah changes by the end. The last stage direction says he ___ touches the sea star. (Type one word.)	**slowly**	The last stage direction says Isaiah takes a breath and slowly touches the sea star. He is not rushing anymore.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
w1_s2	Set 3: *The Folded Map Scene 1: The aquarium lobby. Morning.JOVAN: (frowning at a map) Which way to the sea otters?INDIRA: (pointing) The map says to go up the stairs.Scene 2: The sea otter pool. A few minutes later.INDIRA: (cheering) There they are!JOVAN: (folding the map) The map helped us after all.* Why does Scene 2 begin? [The place changes from the lobby to the otter pool, and time moves ahead. / Indira starts to talk. / Jovan asks a question. / The map is folded in Scene 1.]	**The place changes from the lobby to the otter pool, and time moves ahead.**	A new scene starts when the place or the time changes. Scene 2 is at the otter pool, a few minutes later.
w2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Look at the scene heading. Scene 1 happens in the aquarium ___.	**lobby** (also accepted: the lobby)	The heading says: Scene 1: The aquarium lobby. Morning.
w3_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Who says, "There they are!" Type the name.	**Indira** (also accepted: indira)	INDIRA: (cheering) There they are! The name before the colon tells who is talking.
w4_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Jovan wrote this summary: "Jovan frowns. Indira points. It is morning." What went wrong? [It lists tiny details but leaves out the problem and the ending: they use the map to find the otters. / It is too long. / It should tell who is in the cast list. / Nothing went wrong.]	**It lists tiny details but leaves out the problem and the ending: they use the map to find the otters.**	A summary tells the important events: Jovan and Indira cannot find the otters, follow the map, and find them.

WHERE IS THE MAIN IDEA HIDING? (3 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t1a_s0	Set 1: Read paragraph 2, Built for Cold Water. Which sentence is its MAIN IDEA? [Their thick, clean fur is what keeps sea otters warm in the cold ocean. / Seals and whales have a thick layer of fat, called blubber, to keep them warm. / The ocean water in Monterey Bay is chilly all year. / Otters spend a lot of time each day cleaning and fluffing their fur.]	**Their thick, clean fur is what keeps sea otters warm in the cold ocean.**	Every other sentence in paragraph 2 helps explain how otters stay warm with fur instead of blubber. The last sentence pulls it all together.
t1b_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: In paragraph 4, the main idea sentence is in the ___ of the paragraph. (Type beginning, middle, or end.)	**middle** (also accepted: the middle, in the middle)	Sea otters help keep the kelp forest healthy is sentence 3 of 5, right in the middle.
t1c_s0	Set 1: Which explanation is correct? Itzel says paragraph 3 has no main idea, because no sentence says it. Joaquin says paragraph 3 does have a main idea, but the reader must put the details together to find it. [Joaquin is right. Every paragraph has a main idea, even when the author does not write it in one sentence. / Itzel is right. If no sentence says it, there is no main idea. / Itzel is right. Only the first paragraph has a main idea. / Neither is right. Main ideas are only in titles.]	**Joaquin is right. Every paragraph has a main idea, even when the author does not write it in one sentence.**	When the main idea is not stated, the details still point to it. You add them up to find it.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t1a_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: In paragraph 2, the main idea sentence is the ___ sentence. (Type first or last.)	**last** (also accepted: the last, last one)	The last sentence, Their thick, clean fur is what keeps sea otters warm, is what all the other sentences explain.
t1b_s1	Set 2: Paragraph 3 does not say its main idea in one sentence. Put the details together. What is the main idea? [Sea otters eat a lot of food and have clever ways to get it. / Sea otters use rocks. / A 60-pound kid would eat 15 pounds of food. / Sea urchins are covered in spines.]	**Sea otters eat a lot of food and have clever ways to get it.**	The details tell how much otters eat, where they dive, where they carry food, and how they crack shells. Together they show that otters eat a lot and have clever ways to get it.
t1c_s1	Set 2: Find the mistake! Joaquin says the main idea of paragraph 4 is "Sea urchins are small, round animals covered in spines," because it is the first sentence. What went wrong? [The main idea is not always first. The other sentences explain how otters keep the forest healthy, so the main idea is the third sentence. / The main idea is always the last sentence. / He should have picked the title of the whole booklet. / Nothing went wrong.]	**The main idea is not always first. The other sentences explain how otters keep the forest healthy, so the main idea is the third sentence.**	Check which sentence the others explain. In paragraph 4, that is Sea otters help keep the kelp forest healthy.
t1a_s2	Set 3: Read paragraph 4, Otters Protect the Forest. Which sentence is its MAIN IDEA? [Sea otters help keep the kelp forest healthy. / Sea urchins are small, round animals covered in spines. / They love to munch on kelp. / When there are too many urchins, they can chew through the kelp until the forest is gone.]	**Sea otters help keep the kelp forest healthy.**	The other sentences explain how otters keep the forest healthy: urchins eat kelp, too many urchins wipe it out, and otters eat the urchins.
t1b_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Paragraph 5 tells its main idea in its ___ sentence. (Type first, middle, or last.)	**first** (also accepted: the first)	The kelp forest helps sea otters, too. That first sentence is what the rest of paragraph 5 explains.
t1c_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Itzel says the main idea of paragraph 2 is "Seals and whales have a thick layer of fat, called blubber," because it has the important word blubber in it. What went wrong? [That sentence is about seals and whales. The rest of the paragraph explains how fur keeps otters warm, so the last sentence is the main idea. / Blubber is not a real word. / The main idea must have a number in it. / Nothing went wrong.]	**That sentence is about seals and whales. The rest of the paragraph explains how fur keeps otters warm, so the last sentence is the main idea.**	An important word does not make a main idea. Ask which sentence all the other sentences help explain.

TOO BIG, TOO SMALL, JUST RIGHT (3 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t2a_s0	Set 1: Which main idea is JUST RIGHT for paragraph 1? [Giant kelp is a tall, fast-growing seaweed that makes an underwater forest. / The ocean has many plants and animals. / Kelp has a holdfast. / Fish swim in the ocean.]	**Giant kelp is a tall, fast-growing seaweed that makes an underwater forest.**	Just right covers all the details: the holdfast, the gas floats, the fast growth, and the animals that hide there. The ocean has many plants and animals is too big. Kelp has a holdfast is too small.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t2b_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: “Sea otters live in the ocean” is a main idea that is too ___ for paragraph 3. (Type big or small.)	**big** (also accepted: too big)	It is true, but it could fit almost any paragraph in the booklet. It does not tell what paragraph 3 is about: how much otters eat and how they get food.
t2c_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Itzel wrote “Animals stay warm in many ways” as the main idea of paragraph 2. It is too big. Fix it so it is just right: Thick, clean ___ keeps sea otters warm in the cold ocean. (Type one word.)	**fur**	Animals stay warm in many ways could fit a whole book. Paragraph 2 is about how thick, clean fur keeps sea otters warm without blubber.
t2a_s1	Set 2: Which main idea is JUST RIGHT for paragraph 5? [The kelp forest helps sea otters by giving them a place to rest and food to eat. / Animals need homes. / A mother otter may wrap her pup in kelp. / Sea urchins munch on kelp.]	**The kelp forest helps sea otters by giving them a place to rest and food to eat.**	Just right covers resting in kelp, wrapping pups, rafts, and food. Animals need homes is too big. Wrapping a pup is only one detail.
t2b_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: “A mother otter may wrap her pup in kelp” is too ___ to be the main idea of paragraph 5. (Type big or small.)	**small** (also accepted: too small)	It is only one detail. The paragraph also tells about resting, rafts, and food.
t2c_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Itzel says “Animals live in the ocean” is too big for paragraph 2. Joaquin says it is just right, because otters are animals that live in the ocean. [Itzel is right. It is true, but it does not tell about fur keeping otters warm, and it could fit almost any paragraph. / Joaquin is right. Any true sentence about otters is just right. / Joaquin is right, because it is short. / Neither is right. It is too small.]	**Itzel is right. It is true, but it does not tell about fur keeping otters warm, and it could fit almost any paragraph.**	A just-right main idea tells what THIS paragraph is mostly about. Paragraph 2 is about how fur keeps otters warm.
t2a_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: “Giant kelp can grow up to two feet in one day” is too ___ to be the main idea of paragraph 1. (Type big or small.)	**small** (also accepted: too small)	It is one interesting detail. Paragraph 1 is about the whole kelp forest: holdfasts, floats, growth, and hiding places.
t2b_s2	Set 3: Which main idea for paragraph 2 is TOO BIG? [Many animals live in cold places. / Thick, clean fur keeps sea otters warm in cold water. / Sea otters do not have blubber. / Otters clean and fluff their fur.]	**Many animals live in cold places.**	Many animals live in cold places could be about polar bears or penguins too. It is much bigger than paragraph 2.
t2c_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Find the mistake! Joaquin says the main idea of paragraph 6 is “The Kelp Forest exhibit is 28 feet tall.” Is his main idea too big or too small? (Type big or small.)	**small** (also accepted: too small)	The height of the exhibit is only one fact, so it is too small. Paragraph 6 is mostly about seeing both partners up close at the aquarium.

KEY DETAILS: PROOF FOR THE MAIN IDEA (3 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t3a_s0	Set 1: Main idea of paragraph 2: Thick, clean fur keeps sea otters warm. Which detail BEST supports it? [Otters have up to one million hairs on a patch of skin the size of a postage stamp. / The Kelp Forest exhibit is 28 feet tall. / Sea urchins are covered in spines. / A mother otter may wrap her pup in kelp.]	**Otters have up to one million hairs on a patch of skin the size of a postage stamp.**	A million hairs on a tiny patch shows how thick the fur is. That helps prove the fur keeps otters warm.
t3b_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Paragraph 4 says otters eat lots of urchins, so the ___ has a chance to keep growing. (Type one word.)	**kelp** (also accepted: the kelp)	Sea otters eat lots of urchins, so the kelp has a chance to keep growing. This detail supports the main idea that otters keep the forest healthy.
t3c_s0	Set 1: Two steps! Paragraph 2 says otters do not have blubber. Step 1: What do they have instead? Step 2: Why is that a key detail? [Thick fur. It explains how otters stay warm without blubber. / A holdfast. It keeps them from drifting away. / Thick fur. It is the softest thing in the ocean. / Gas floats. They keep otters near the sunlight.]	**Thick fur. It explains how otters stay warm without blubber.**	Instead of blubber, otters have the thickest fur of any animal. That detail proves how they stay warm, which is the main idea.
t3a_s1	Set 2: Look at the table. Which key detail could hold up the empty leg? [A mother otter may wrap her pup in kelp while she dives for food. / Giant kelp can grow up to two feet in one day. / Seals and whales have blubber. / The aquarium is in Monterey, California.]	**A mother otter may wrap her pup in kelp while she dives for food.**	The tabletop says the kelp forest helps otters. Wrapping a pup in kelp shows one way it helps. The kelp growth fact is true, but it does not show how kelp helps otters.
t3b_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: Paragraph 3 says otters carry food in a loose pocket of ___ under each front leg. (Type one word.)	**skin**	They tuck the food into a loose pocket of skin under each front leg. It is one clever way otters get their food.
t3c_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Itzel says “Giant kelp can grow up to two feet in one day” supports the main idea of paragraph 5, because it is about kelp. Joaquin says it is a true fact, but it does not show how the kelp forest helps otters. [Joaquin is right. A key detail must help explain the main idea, not just be about the same topic. / Itzel is right. Any fact about kelp supports any paragraph. / Itzel is right, because it is the most exciting fact. / Neither is right. Paragraph 5 has no key details.]	**Joaquin is right. A key detail must help explain the main idea, not just be about the same topic.**	Paragraph 5 is about how the forest helps otters. Growing fast is interesting, but it does not show that.
t3a_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Two steps! A sea otter eats about one-fourth of its body weight in food each day. About how many pounds would a 40-pound otter eat in one day? (Type the number.)	**10** (also accepted: ten, 10 pounds, ten pounds)	One-fourth of 40 is 10, because 40 split into 4 equal parts is 10 in each part. This detail supports the main idea that otters eat a lot.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t3b_s2	Set 3: Main idea of paragraph 4: Sea otters help keep the kelp forest healthy. Which detail does NOT support it? [Sea otters have up to one million hairs on a patch of skin. / Too many urchins can chew through the kelp. / Sea otters eat lots of urchins. / Sea urchins love to munch on kelp.]	**Sea otters have up to one million hairs on a patch of skin.**	The fur fact is true, but it belongs with paragraph 2. It does not explain how otters keep the forest healthy.
t3c_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Joaquin explains: "The rock detail supports paragraph 3 because rocks are hard." What went wrong? [His reason does not connect to the main idea. The rock detail supports it because it shows a clever way otters get their food. / Otters do not use rocks. / The rock detail belongs in paragraph 1. / Nothing went wrong.]	**His reason does not connect to the main idea. The rock detail supports it because it shows a clever way otters get their food.**	To explain a key detail, tell HOW it helps the main idea. Using a rock to crack shells is a clever way to eat.

THE MAIN IDEA OF THE WHOLE TEXT (3 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t4a_s0	Set 1: What is the main idea of the WHOLE booklet? [Sea otters and kelp forests help each other. / Sea otters use rocks to crack shells. / The water in Monterey Bay is chilly. / Kelp has a holdfast.]	**Sea otters and kelp forests help each other.**	Paragraph 4 says otters protect the kelp, and paragraph 5 says the kelp helps otters. The title, Partners, and the last sentence point to it too.
t4b_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: The title Partners in the Kelp Forest is a clue. Partners are living things that ___ each other. (Type one word.)	**help**	Partners help each other. The otters help the kelp, and the kelp helps the otters.
t4c_s0	Set 1: Which is the BEST retelling of paragraph 4? [Sea otters keep the kelp forest healthy. Urchins eat kelp, and too many can wipe out a forest, but otters eat the urchins. / Urchins are round. They have spines. They are small. / I think sea otters are the cutest animals in the ocean. / Otters wrap themselves in kelp to rest. Kelp grows fast.]	**Sea otters keep the kelp forest healthy. Urchins eat kelp, and too many can wipe out a forest, but otters eat the urchins.**	A good retelling says the main idea first, then a few key details in your own words. It leaves out opinions and details from other paragraphs.
t4a_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: Paragraph 4 tells how otters help the kelp. Paragraph ___ tells how the kelp helps otters. (Type the number.)	**5** (also accepted: five, paragraph 5)	Paragraph 5 begins: The kelp forest helps sea otters, too.
t4b_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: One sentence in paragraph 6 states the main idea of the WHOLE booklet. Which sentence number is it? (Type the number.)	**5** (also accepted: five, sentence 5)	Sentence 5, the last sentence of the booklet, says: Sea otters and kelp forests help each other. It ties every paragraph together.
t4c_s1	Set 2: Find the mistake! Itzel says the main idea of the whole booklet is "Sea otters have thick fur," because paragraph 2 is her favorite. What went wrong? [That is the main idea of only one paragraph. The main idea of the whole booklet must connect all the paragraphs. / Sea otters do not have thick fur. / Paragraph 2 is the last paragraph. / Nothing went wrong.]	**That is the main idea of only one paragraph. The main idea of the whole booklet must connect all the paragraphs.**	Your favorite part is not always the main idea. Look for what ALL the paragraphs build together: otters and kelp help each other.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t4a_s2	Set 3: Two steps! Step 1: Find the main ideas of paragraphs 4 and 5. Step 2: Put them together. What do you get? [Otters keep the kelp healthy, and kelp helps otters, so they are partners. / Urchins eat kelp, so urchins are the main idea. / Otters rest in rafts, so the booklet is about boats. / Kelp grows fast, so the booklet is about plants only.]	**Otters keep the kelp healthy, and kelp helps otters, so they are partners.**	Paragraph 4: otters help the forest. Paragraph 5: the forest helps otters. Together: they help each other.
t4b_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Joaquin retells paragraph 3: "Sea otters eat a lot of food. They dive for clams and urchins and crack shells with a ___." (Type one word.)	**rock** (also accepted: a rock, stone, a stone)	Paragraph 3 says an otter floats on its back and uses a rock to crack open hard shells.
t4c_s2	Set 3: Which new title would tell the SAME main idea as the whole booklet? [Otters and Kelp: A Team Under the Sea / How to Crack a Clam / The Biggest Fish in the Bay / All About Seals and Whales]	**Otters and Kelp: A Team Under the Sea**	A team works together, just like partners. The other titles fit only one detail or a different topic.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match Main idea	**the most important point of a paragraph**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match Key detail	**a fact that supports the main idea**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match Too big	**could fit a whole book**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match Too small	**only one detail**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match Just right	**covers all the details in the paragraph**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match Holdfast	**grips a rock on the sea floor**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match Blubber	**a thick layer of fat**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match Raft	**a group of otters resting together**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match Sea urchin	**a spiny animal that munches kelp**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match Gas-filled floats	**lift kelp toward the sunlight**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match Paragraph 2	**thick fur keeps otters warm**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match Paragraph 3	**otters eat a lot of food**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match Paragraph 4	**otters keep the forest healthy**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match Paragraph 5	**the forest helps otters**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match Paragraph 6	**see the partners up close**	2 points if matched on the first try.

FIX THE SENTENCE (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fx1_s0	Set 1: Fix the sentence. A sentence and a name need capital letters. itzel saw a raft of otters.	**Itzel saw a raft of otters.**	Every sentence starts with a capital letter. Itzel is a name, so it gets a capital I.
fx2_s0	Set 1: Fix the sentence. This asking sentence needs the right end mark. Do sea otters have blubber	**Do sea otters have blubber?**	An asking sentence ends with a question mark.
fx1_s1	Set 2: Fix the sentence. Add commas to separate the things in the list. Otters eat clams crabs snails and urchins.	**Otters eat clams, crabs, snails, and urchins.** (also accepted: Otters eat clams, crabs, snails and urchins.)	Use commas to separate three or more things in a list: clams, crabs, snails, and urchins.
fx2_s1	Set 2: Fix the sentence. The names of a city and a state need capital letters. The aquarium is in monterey, california.	**The aquarium is in Monterey, California.**	Monterey is the name of a city and California is the name of a state, so both get capital letters.
fx1_s2	Set 3: Fix the sentence. Fix the one grammar mistake. The sea otters floats on their backs.	**The sea otters float on their backs.**	Otters is more than one, so the verb is float, not floats.
fx2_s2	Set 3: Fix the sentence. Two names need capital letters. joaquin and itzel read the booklet.	**Joaquin and Itzel read the booklet.**	Joaquin and Itzel are names, so both get capital letters. Joaquin also starts the sentence.

⌨ TYPE-IT CORRAL (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
ty1_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Seals and whales stay warm with a thick layer of fat called ___.	**blubber**	Paragraph 2: Seals and whales have a thick layer of fat, called blubber.
ty2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Giant kelp can grow up to ___ feet in just one day. (Type the number.)	**2** (also accepted: two, 2 feet, two feet)	Paragraph 1: Giant kelp can grow up to two feet in just one day!
ty3_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: A group of sea otters resting together is called a ___.	**raft** (also accepted: a raft)	Paragraph 5: A group of otters resting together is called a raft.
ty1_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: A kelp plant grips a rock on the sea floor with a ___.	**holdfast** (also accepted: a holdfast)	Paragraph 1: Each kelp plant grips a rock on the sea floor with a holdfast.
ty2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: The Kelp Forest exhibit at the aquarium is ___ feet tall. (Type the number.)	**28** (also accepted: twenty-eight, twenty eight, 28 feet)	Paragraph 6: The Kelp Forest exhibit is 28 feet tall.
ty3_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: Sea otters eat lots of sea ___, so the kelp can keep growing.	**urchins** (also accepted: urchin)	Paragraph 4: Sea otters eat lots of urchins, so the kelp has a chance to keep growing.
ty1_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Small balls filled with ___ float the kelp up toward the sunlight.	**gas**	Paragraph 1: Small balls filled with gas float the kelp up toward the sunlight.
ty2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: The Monterey Bay Aquarium is in the city of ___, California.	**Monterey** (also accepted: monterey)	Paragraph 6: At the Monterey Bay Aquarium in Monterey, California.
ty3_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Sea otters have up to one ___ hairs on a patch of skin the size of a postage stamp.	**million** (also accepted: 1 million, 1,000,000, one million)	Paragraph 2: up to one million hairs on a patch of skin about the size of a postage stamp.

BOSS BATTLE: KELP FOREST CHALLENGE (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
bb1_s0	Set 1: Paragraph 1 is about the kelp forest. Which detail explains HOW the kelp stands up tall in the water? [Small balls filled with gas float the kelp up toward the sunlight. / Fish, crabs, and snails find hiding places in the kelp. / Giant kelp can grow up to two feet in just one day! / A holdfast looks like roots, but it only holds on.]	**Small balls filled with gas float the kelp up toward the sunlight.**	The gas-filled floats lift the kelp up. The holdfast only grips the rock at the bottom.
bb2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Two steps! A sea otter eats about one-fourth of its body weight each day. How many pounds would a 48-pound otter eat in one day? (Type the number.)	**12** (also accepted: twelve, 12 pounds, twelve pounds)	48 split into 4 equal parts is 12, because 4 times 12 is 48.
bb3_s0	Set 1: Find the mistake! Joaquin wrote: “Main idea of paragraph 2: Sea otters do not have blubber. Key detail: Otters fluff their fur.” What went wrong? [His main idea is too small. The main idea is that thick, clean fur keeps otters warm, and fluffing the fur supports that. / His key detail is from paragraph 5. / Sea otters do have blubber. / Nothing went wrong.]	**His main idea is too small. The main idea is that thick, clean fur keeps otters warm, and fluffing the fur supports that.**	Having no blubber is one detail. The sentence that all the details explain is the last one: fur keeps otters warm.
bb4_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Paragraph 3 has no main idea sentence. Finish it in your own words: Sea otters eat a lot of ___ and have clever ways to get it.	**food**	Every detail in paragraph 3 is about eating: how much, where they dive, the skin pocket, and the rock.
bb1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Itzel says the main idea of paragraph 6 is “You can see both partners up close at the aquarium.” Joaquin says it is “Rescued sea otters groom their fur.” [Itzel is right. The other sentences tell what you can see there: the kelp exhibit and the rescued otters. / Joaquin is right, because grooming is the most fun detail. / Joaquin is right, because it is the longest sentence. / Neither is right. Paragraph 6 has no main idea.]	**Itzel is right. The other sentences tell what you can see there: the kelp exhibit and the rescued otters.**	Grooming otters is only one detail. The first sentence is what the whole paragraph explains.
bb2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: Count the sentences in paragraph 4. The main idea is sentence number ___. (Type the number.)	**3** (also accepted: three, sentence 3)	Sentence 1: urchins have spines. Sentence 2: they munch kelp. Sentence 3: Sea otters help keep the kelp forest healthy. That is the main idea.
bb3_s1	Set 2: Two steps! Use paragraph 4. What would MOST LIKELY happen to a kelp forest if all the sea otters left? [The urchins would grow in number and could chew through the kelp until the forest is gone. / The kelp would grow faster than ever. / The urchins would move away to find otters. / Nothing would change.]	**The urchins would grow in number and could chew through the kelp until the forest is gone.**	Step 1: Otters eat urchins. Step 2: Without otters, there would be too many urchins, and too many urchins can chew through the kelp.
bb4_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: One detail supports BOTH paragraph 3 (otters eat a lot) AND paragraph 4 (otters keep the forest healthy): sea otters eat sea ___.	**urchins** (also accepted: urchin, sea urchins)	Eating urchins is part of how otters get food AND how they protect the kelp. One detail can support two main ideas.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
bb1_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Paragraph 2 compares otters with seals and whales. Seals and whales have blubber, but sea otters stay warm with thick ___.	**fur**	Sea otters do not have blubber. Instead, they have the thickest fur of any animal on Earth.
bb2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Itzel says "Giant kelp is a seaweed that grows so tall it makes a forest under the ocean" is too big to be the main idea of paragraph 1. What went wrong? [It is just right. Every other sentence tells about the kelp forest: its holdfast, its floats, how fast it grows, and who hides there. / It is too small, because it is only one detail. / It is not about the ocean. / Nothing went wrong.]	**It is just right. Every other sentence tells about the kelp forest: its holdfast, its floats, how fast it grows, and who hides there.**	Too big would fit a whole book, like The ocean is full of life. This sentence fits paragraph 1 exactly.
bb3_s2	Set 3: Which is the BEST retelling of paragraph 2? [Sea otters have no blubber, so they stay warm with super thick fur. They clean and fluff it to trap air next to their skin. / Seals and whales have blubber. The bay is chilly. / Otters are so fluffy and cute. I want one as a pet. / Otters crack shells with rocks and rest in rafts.]	**Sea otters have no blubber, so they stay warm with super thick fur. They clean and fluff it to trap air next to their skin.**	The best retelling gives the main idea plus key details from paragraph 2, in your own words, with no opinions.
bb4_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Two steps! The Kelp Forest exhibit is 28 feet tall. If kelp grew 2 feet every day, how many days would it take to grow 28 feet? (Type the number.)	**14** (also accepted: fourteen, 14 days, fourteen days)	28 feet split into 2-foot days is 14 days, because 14 times 2 is 28.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W21.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: JUNIE: (whispering) The otters are asleep.	Junie is speaking. Stage direction: (whispering).
2	The main idea of a paragraph is ...	the most important point
3	Which sentence do the other sentences help explain?	Kelp grows so tall that it makes a forest under the sea. (It is the last sentence.)
4	Main idea: Sea otters eat a lot of food. Detail that does NOT support it	Kelp is green.
5	Draw a sea otter in the kelp and write one fact	Answers vary. Accept any true fact, such as: sea otters float on their backs.

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Otter Toolbox: main idea sentence and where it is	Sea otters are one of the few animals that use tools. It is in the middle (the second of four sentences).
2	Too big, too small or just right	a) too big b) too small c) just right

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
3	Joaquin says “An otter dives to the sea floor” because it comes first	The main idea is not always first. That sentence is only one detail; the other sentences explain how otters use tools, so the main idea is “Sea otters are one of the few animals that use tools.”
4	Two key details that prove the main idea, with because	Example: An otter tucks a rock under its front leg. This supports the main idea because the rock is a tool. It cracks the clam on the rock, which supports the main idea because it uses the rock as a tool to get food.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Main idea of the WHOLE booklet in your own words	Answers vary in wording. Model: Sea otters and kelp forests help each other; they are partners.